> Also, these States could enter into alliances with each other with the exception of alliances against the Empire;
> 3. Those Christian citizens whose denominational affiliation was different from that of the State were guaranteed the freedom of conscience to practise in private and limited rights to practise in public. In other words, religious ‘minorities’ in this context were denominational minorities from *within* the same religion, namely Christianity, and their ability to practise their denominational faith in public was contingent upon the goodwill of the State and therefore, the majority denomination; and
> 4. Calvinism, which was previously not recognised as one of the permanent denominations of Christianity under the Peace of Augsburg of 1555, was included as the third official permanent denomination.

Given the drastic truncation, if not complete elimination, of both the papacy and the overlordship of the Holy Roman Empire, Pope Innocent X issued a papal bull, *Zel Domus*, which declared the Westphalian Peace treaties ‘null, void, invalid, iniquitous, unjust, damnable, reprobate, inane, empty of meaning and effect for all time’.[17] Anticipating this papal tantrum, the Peace of Westphalia contained a clause that pre-emptively stated that the pope’s protests would not render the treaties void.

That the Christian Peace of Westphalia laid the foundation for sovereign nation-states is evident from the definition of the State in the Montevideo Convention on the Rights and Duties of States (1933).[18] Article 1 of the said convention reads as under:

> The state as a person of international law should possess the following qualifications: (*a*) a permanent population; (*b*) a defined territory; (*c*) government; and (*d*) capacity to enter into relations with the other states.

The purpose of the preceding not-so-brief historical discussion was to demonstrate and advance the point that the Peace of Westphalia was distinctly Christian in nature, which has been secularised over time.[19] In fact, while it is true that the Peace of Westphalia resulted in a transition of hegemony from the Habsburg Empire to sovereign States, parties to the peace saw themselves as ‘the Senate of Christian Europe’. Thanks to their